

Recipe card swap station

Category	Recipe cards - Take-home - Reference
Skill level	Grab & go once printed. Hand out tested-recipe cards and chat about them. Refer technique questions to a Master Food Preserver.
Audience	Adults. Tested home-canning recipes from OSU/USDA publications, with full citations.
Setup time	5-10 minutes (printing and cutting)

IMPORTANT - verify before you distribute: these cards were extracted from the cited publications by an assistant. A Master Food Preserver must confirm each recipe against its source publication (using the Recipe index) before printing for the public. Never hand out a canning recipe you have not checked against its tested source.

DESCRIPTION

A take-one / swap-one station of TESTED recipe cards (4x6) drawn from OSU and USDA publications - jam, salsa, pickles, canned fruit, green beans, and more. Each card carries the exact ingredients, headspace, processing time, yield, the source citation, and a tested-recipe safety reminder. Visitors browse, take the cards they want, and (optionally) swap a family recipe to chat about with a Master Food Preserver.

MATERIALS NEEDED

Print (hand out / swap)

- The "recipe-cards-all.pdf" deck (4x6 cards, 2 per page). Print on card stock and cut. Every card has its source citation and the tested-recipe disclaimer.
- The "Recipe index" (recipe-index.pdf) - every recipe with its full citation and a verification note. Use it to confirm each recipe against its source before printing for the public.

Digital version (tablet)

- Open the browser: sign in to the MFP Volunteer Resource Hub, tap "Outreach," then "Play on tablet" on the Recipe card swap station card. Search or filter by method and tap a recipe to view it.

Both

- Table and MFP / OSU Extension signage. Blank cards or slips if you want visitors to write a recipe to swap.
- This Activity guide on the table.

SETUP

1. A Master Food Preserver: check each recipe in the Recipe index against its cited OSU/USDA publication before printing the cards.
2. Print and cut the recipe cards you want to offer; lay them out so visitors can browse and take one.
3. Optional: set out blank cards for visitors to write a family recipe to swap and discuss.

ACTIVITY DIRECTIONS

Running it

1. Invite visitors to browse the tested recipe cards and take any they like.
2. Point out the source citation and the reminder to follow the tested recipe exactly.
3. If a visitor wants to swap a family recipe, take a look and use it to start a conversation about tested vs. untested recipes - never endorse an untested canning recipe.
4. Refer "is my recipe safe?" questions to a Master Food Preserver or the OSU Extension hotline.

VOLUNTEER NOTES

- Every card is a TESTED recipe with a source citation - that is the whole point. Do not hand out altered or untested canning recipes.
- Verify first: confirm each recipe against its cited publication before printing for the public (see the Recipe index).
- Tell visitors to follow tested recipes exactly - do not change ingredients, proportions, or processing times. That message is printed on every card.
- For swapped family recipes, be encouraging but honest: suggest they have it checked against a tested recipe before canning it.
- Refer detailed recipe or safety questions to a Master Food Preserver or OSU Extension.